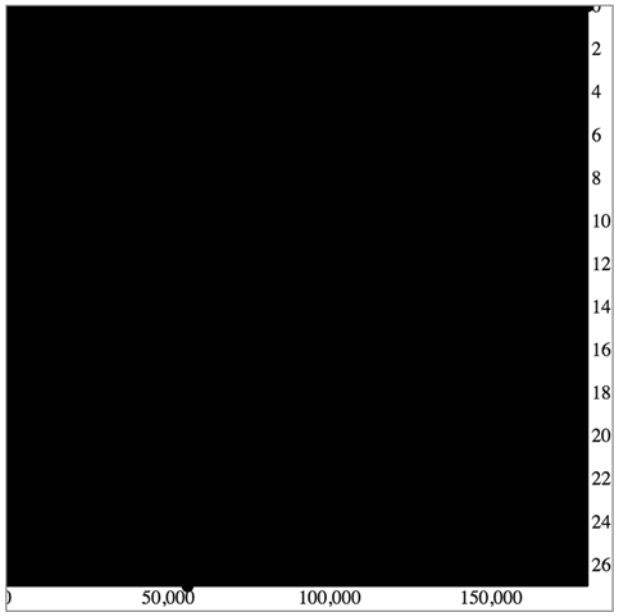


Figure 4.8 Setting axis ticks to the size of your canvas also sets `<path.domain>` to the size of your canvas. Because paths are, by default, filled with black, the result is illegible.

Notice that the `<g>` element has been created with classes, so we can style the child elements (our line and our label) using CSS, or select them with D3. This is necessary if we want our axes to be displayed properly, with lines corresponding to the labeled points. Why? Because along with lines and labels, the axis code has drawn the `<path.domain>` to cover the entire region contained by the axis elements. This domain element needs to be set to `"fill: none"`, or we'll end up with a big black square. You'll also see examples where the tick lines are drawn with negative lengths to create a slightly different visual style. For our axis to make sense, we could continue to apply inline styles by using `d3.select` to modify the styles of the necessary elements, but instead we should use CSS, because it's easier to maintain and doesn't require us to write styles on the fly in JavaScript. The following listing shows a short CSS style sheet that corresponds to the elements created by the axis function.

Listing 4.1 ch4stylesheet.css

```
<style>
line {
  shape-rendering: crispEdges;
  stroke: #000;
}

path.domain {
  fill: none;
  stroke: black;
}
</style>
```

This applies to all our lines, which includes the major lines that we'd otherwise need to reference with "g.major > line".